



Date with destiny: If Gukesh defeats Ding Liren, he will not only become the 18th World Chess Champion but also, at just 18 years old, the youngest World Chess Champion in history. LENNART OOTES/FIDE

History beckons as Gukesh and Ding battle for supremacy in Singapore

If D. Gukesh becomes the 18th World Champion, it will mark **yet another great moment** for Indian chess, especially in a year when the country secured twin golds at the Olympiad.

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If you want to search for the most exclusive clubs in international sport, you needn't look beyond the one reserved for the World Chess Champions. In the

tournament's history, dating back to 1886, there have been only 17 World Champions. **And we will soon know if we will get the 18th after the World championship match that kicks off in Singapore on November 23.**

If D. Gukesh, the 18-year-old from Chennai, beats Ding Liren of China,

he will become not just the 18th World Champion but also the youngest in history. He will break the record set by Garry Kasparov in 1985.

Kasparov became the 13th World Champion after defeating fellow Soviet Union player Anatoly Karpov in a remarkable match that lasted —